

CSS Search Text

Complete Guide: Easy English Edition

Master search input styling and text search highlighting in modern CSS

Contents

1	Introduction	2
1.1	What is Search Text in CSS?	2
1.2	Why Style Search Elements?	2
2	Search Input Basics	3
2.1	What is the Search Input?	3
2.1.1	Basic HTML	3
2.1.2	Basic Styling	3
2.2	Search Input Properties	3
2.3	Styling the Search Input	3
2.3.1	Example 1: Simple Search Box	3
2.3.2	Example 2: Search with Icon	4
2.3.3	Example 3: Clear Button	4
3	Search Input Pseudo-Elements	5
3.1	::webkit-search-cancel-button	5
3.2	::webkit-search-results-button	5
3.3	::placeholder	5
4	Text Highlighting and Search Results	6
4.1	Highlighting Found Text	6
4.1.1	Using the Mark Element	6
4.1.2	Using CSS Classes	6
4.1.3	Example: Search Results Page	6
5	Complete Search Interface	8
5.1	Example 1: Header Search Bar	8
5.2	Example 2: Search Results Page	8
5.3	Example 3: Autocomplete Search	9
6	Search with Filters	11
6.1	Example: Search with Category Filters	11
7	Advanced Search Styling	12
7.1	Search with Suggestions	12
7.2	Recent Searches	12
8	Mobile Search	14
8.1	Mobile-Optimized Search	14
9	Search Animations	15
9.1	Expanding Search Box	15
9.2	Loading Animation	15

10 Accessibility	16
10.1 Accessible Search	16
10.2 Color Contrast	16
11 Browser Support	17
11.1 Compatibility	17
11.2 Fallback for Older Browsers	17
12 Common Mistakes	18
12.1 Mistake 1: Insufficient Padding	18
12.2 Mistake 2: Forgetting Focus States	18
12.3 Mistake 3: Poor Highlight Contrast	18
13 Quick Reference	20
13.1 Search Input Styling	20
13.2 Text Highlighting	20
13.3 Key Properties	21

1 Introduction

CSS Search Text properties help you style search inputs and highlight searched text on web pages. From customizing the search input box to highlighting search results, CSS gives you complete control!

1.1 What is Search Text in CSS?

Search text styling includes:

- **Search Input:** Styling the `<input type="search">` element
- **Text Highlighting:** Marking found text with CSS
- **Search UI:** Building complete search interfaces
- **Results Display:** Styling search result pages

1.2 Why Style Search Elements?

- **Better UX:** Clear search interface improves usability
- **Visual Feedback:** Users see their search is active
- **Accessibility:** Proper styling helps all users
- **Brand Consistency:** Match your design system
- **Mobile Friendly:** Adapt search for touch devices

2 Search Input Basics

2.1 What is the Search Input?

The HTML5 search input is a specialized input type for search queries.

2.1.1 Basic HTML

```
<input type="search" placeholder="Search...">
```

2.1.2 Basic Styling

```
input[type="search"] {  
  padding: 10px 15px;  
  border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;  
  border-radius: 8px;  
  font-size: 16px;  
  font-family: inherit;  
}
```

2.2 Search Input Properties

Property	Purpose
width	Control input width
padding	Space inside input
border	Input border styling
border-radius	Rounded corners
background	Input background color
color	Text color
font-size	Text size
outline	Focus outline

2.3 Styling the Search Input

2.3.1 Example 1: Simple Search Box

```
input[type="search"] {  
  width: 100%;  
  max-width: 400px;  
  padding: 12px 16px;  
  border: 2px solid #E0E0E0;
```

```

border-radius: 8px;
font-size: 16px;
transition: border-color 0.3s;
}

input[type="search"]:focus {
  outline: none;
  border-color: #2196F3;
  box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(33, 150, 243, 0.1);
}

```

2.3.2 Example 2: Search with Icon

```

.search-wrapper {
  position: relative;
  display: inline-block;
}

input[type="search"] {
  width: 100%;
  padding: 12px 16px 12px 40px;
  border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;
  border-radius: 8px;
}

.search-icon {
  position: absolute;
  left: 12px;
  top: 50%;
  transform: translateY(-50%);
  color: #999;
}

```

2.3.3 Example 3: Clear Button

```

input[type="search"]::-webkit-search-cancel-button {
  cursor: pointer;
  -webkit-appearance: none;
  appearance: none;
  height: 16px;
  width: 16px;
  background: url('clear-icon.svg');
  background-size: 16px;
}

input[type="search"]::-webkit-search-results-button {
  display: none;
}

```

3 Search Input Pseudo-Elements

3.1 `::-webkit-search-cancel-button`

Style the clear button (X) in search inputs:

```
input[type="search"]::-webkit-search-cancel-button {  
  -webkit-appearance: none;  
  appearance: none;  
  height: 18px;  
  width: 18px;  
  background-color: #999;  
  cursor: pointer;  
  mask-image: url('data:image/svg+xml...');  
}
```

3.2 `::-webkit-search-results-button`

Hide the search results button (magnifying glass):

```
input[type="search"]::-webkit-search-results-button {  
  display: none; /* Hide it */  
}
```

3.3 `::placeholder`

Style the placeholder text:

```
input[type="search"]::placeholder {  
  color: #999;  
  font-style: italic;  
  opacity: 0.7;  
}  
  
input[type="search"]:focus::placeholder {  
  color: #BBB;  
}
```


4 Text Highlighting and Search Results

4.1 Highlighting Found Text

Use the `<mark>` element or CSS classes to highlight search results.

4.1.1 Using the Mark Element

```
/* HTML: <p>Find this <mark>search</mark> term</p> */

mark {
  background-color: #FFEB3B;
  color: #333;
  padding: 2px 4px;
  border-radius: 2px;
  font-weight: 500;
}
```

4.1.2 Using CSS Classes

```
.highlight {
  background-color: #FFD54F;
  color: #333;
  padding: 2px 4px;
  font-weight: bold;
}

.highlight.active {
  background-color: #FF9800;
}
```

4.1.3 Example: Search Results Page

```
.search-result {
  background: white;
  border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;
  border-radius: 8px;
  padding: 16px;
  margin-bottom: 12px;
}

.search-result-title {
  font-size: 18px;
  font-weight: bold;
  color: #2196F3;
  margin-bottom: 8px;
}
```

```
.search-result-excerpt {  
  color: #666;  
  line-height: 1.6;  
}  
  
.search-result-excerpt mark {  
  background-color: #FFE33B;  
  padding: 2px 4px;  
  font-weight: bold;  
}
```

5 Complete Search Interface

5.1 Example 1: Header Search Bar

```
.header-search {
  display: flex;
  align-items: center;
  gap: 8px;
  background: white;
  padding: 12px 16px;
  border-radius: 8px;
  box-shadow: 0 2px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);
}

.header-search input[type="search"] {
  flex: 1;
  min-width: 200px;
  border: none;
  font-size: 16px;
  outline: none;
}

.header-search-icon {
  color: #999;
  cursor: pointer;
}
```

5.2 Example 2: Search Results Page

```
.search-container {
  max-width: 800px;
  margin: 0 auto;
  padding: 20px;
}

.search-input-box {
  margin-bottom: 30px;
}

.search-input-box input {
  width: 100%;
  padding: 16px 20px;
  font-size: 18px;
  border: 2px solid #E0E0E0;
  border-radius: 8px;
}
```

```
.search-stats {
  color: #666;
  margin-bottom: 20px;
  font-size: 14px;
}

.search-results {
  display: flex;
  flex-direction: column;
  gap: 16px;
}

.result-item {
  background: white;
  border-radius: 8px;
  padding: 20px;
  border-left: 4px solid #2196F3;
}

.result-title {
  font-size: 18px;
  font-weight: bold;
  color: #2196F3;
  margin-bottom: 8px;
}

.result-url {
  color: #666;
  font-size: 14px;
  margin-bottom: 8px;
}

.result-snippet {
  color: #333;
  line-height: 1.6;
}
```

5.3 Example 3: Autocomplete Search

```
.autocomplete-container {
  position: relative;
  width: 100%;
}

.autocomplete-input {
  width: 100%;
  padding: 12px 16px;
  border: 2px solid #E0E0E0;
  border-radius: 8px;
  font-size: 16px;
}

.autocomplete-list {
  position: absolute;
  top: 100%;
  left: 0;
```

```
    right: 0;
    background: white;
    border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;
    border-top: none;
    border-radius: 0 0 8px 8px;
    max-height: 300px;
    overflow-y: auto;
    display: none;
    z-index: 10;
}

.autocomplete-list.active {
    display: block;
}

.autocomplete-item {
    padding: 12px 16px;
    cursor: pointer;
    transition: background 0.2s;
}

.autocomplete-item:hover {
    background: #F5F5F5;
}

.autocomplete-item.selected {
    background: #E3F2FD;
    color: #2196F3;
}
```

6 Search with Filters

6.1 Example: Search with Category Filters

```
.search-with-filters {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: 250px 1fr;
  gap: 30px;
}

.filters-sidebar {
  background: #F5F5F5;
  padding: 20px;
  border-radius: 8px;
}

.filter-group {
  margin-bottom: 20px;
}

.filter-title {
  font-weight: bold;
  margin-bottom: 12px;
  font-size: 14px;
}

.filter-option {
  display: flex;
  align-items: center;
  gap: 8px;
  margin-bottom: 8px;
}

.filter-option input[type="checkbox"] {
  cursor: pointer;
  width: 16px;
  height: 16px;
}

.filter-option label {
  cursor: pointer;
  flex: 1;
}

.search-results-area {
  display: flex;
  flex-direction: column;
  gap: 16px;
}
```

7 Advanced Search Styling

7.1 Search with Suggestions

```
.search-with-suggestions {  
  position: relative;  
}  
  
.suggestions-box {  
  position: absolute;  
  top: 100%;  
  left: 0;  
  right: 0;  
  background: white;  
  border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;  
  border-radius: 0 0 8px 8px;  
  max-height: 250px;  
  overflow-y: auto;  
  box-shadow: 0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);  
}  
  
.suggestion-item {  
  padding: 12px 16px;  
  border-bottom: 1px solid #F0F0F0;  
  cursor: pointer;  
  transition: background 0.2s;  
}  
  
.suggestion-item:last-child {  
  border-bottom: none;  
}  
  
.suggestion-item:hover {  
  background: #F5F5F5;  
}  
  
.suggestion-icon {  
  display: inline-block;  
  color: #999;  
  margin-right: 8px;  
}
```

7.2 Recent Searches

```
.recent-searches {  
  padding: 16px;  
  background: #F9F9F9;
```

```
    border-radius: 8px;
}

.recent-title {
    font-weight: bold;
    margin-bottom: 12px;
    font-size: 14px;
}

.recent-item {
    display: inline-block;
    padding: 6px 12px;
    background: white;
    border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;
    border-radius: 20px;
    margin-right: 8px;
    margin-bottom: 8px;
    cursor: pointer;
    transition: all 0.2s;
}

.recent-item:hover {
    background: #E3F2FD;
    border-color: #2196F3;
}

.recent-item .remove {
    margin-left: 8px;
    cursor: pointer;
}
```


8 Mobile Search

8.1 Mobile-Optimized Search

```
.mobile-search {  
  width: 100%;  
  padding: 12px;  
  background: white;  
}  
  
.mobile-search-input {  
  width: 100%;  
  padding: 12px 16px;  
  border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;  
  border-radius: 8px;  
  font-size: 16px;  
  -webkit-appearance: none;  
}  
  
/* Prevent zoom on focus */  
input[type="search"] {  
  font-size: 16px;  
}  
  
@media (max-width: 768px) {  
  .search-container {  
    padding: 12px;  
  }  
  
  .search-with-filters {  
    grid-template-columns: 1fr;  
    gap: 20px;  
  }  
  
  .filters-sidebar {  
    display: none;  
  }  
}
```

9 Search Animations

9.1 Expanding Search Box

```
.expandable-search {  
  position: relative;  
}  
  
.search-toggle {  
  cursor: pointer;  
  font-size: 20px;  
}  
  
.search-input {  
  position: absolute;  
  right: 0;  
  width: 0;  
  border: none;  
  border-bottom: 2px solid #2196F3;  
  outline: none;  
  transition: width 0.3s ease;  
}  
  
.search-input.active {  
  width: 300px;  
  padding: 8px 12px;  
}
```

9.2 Loading Animation

```
.search-loading {  
  display: inline-block;  
  width: 20px;  
  height: 20px;  
  border: 3px solid #F3F3F3;  
  border-top: 3px solid #2196F3;  
  border-radius: 50%;  
  animation: spin 1s linear infinite;  
}  
  
@keyframes spin {  
  0% { transform: rotate(0deg); }  
  100% { transform: rotate(360deg); }  
}
```

10 Accessibility

10.1 Accessible Search

```
.search-form {
  display: flex;
  align-items: center;
}

.search-label {
  display: none; /* Hidden but accessible */
}

input[type="search"] {
  aria-label: "Search";
  aria-describedby: "search-help";
}

input[type="search"]:focus {
  outline: 2px solid #2196F3;
  outline-offset: 2px;
}

.search-help {
  font-size: 12px;
  color: #666;
  margin-top: 4px;
}
```

10.2 Color Contrast

```
/* High contrast for accessibility */
input[type="search"] {
  color: #000;
  background: white;
  border: 2px solid #333;
}

mark {
  background-color: #FFFF00;
  color: #000;
  font-weight: bold;
}
```

11 Browser Support

11.1 Compatibility

Browser	Support
Chrome	All versions
Firefox	All versions
Safari	All versions
Edge	All versions
Opera	All versions
IE 11	Partial support
IE 10	NOT SUPPORTED

11.2 Fallback for Older Browsers

```
/* Standard styling that works everywhere */
input[type="search"] {
  padding: 10px;
  border: 1px solid #CCC;
  border-radius: 4px;
}

/* Enhanced styling for modern browsers */
input[type="search"]::-webkit-search-cancel-button {
  -webkit-appearance: none;
  width: 16px;
  height: 16px;
  background-image: url('clear.svg');
}
```

12 Common Mistakes

12.1 Mistake 1: Insufficient Padding

DON'T:

```
input[type="search"] {  
  padding: 2px; /* Too small! */  
}
```

DO:

```
input[type="search"] {  
  padding: 10px 15px; /* Comfortable */  
  font-size: 16px;  
}
```

12.2 Mistake 2: Forgetting Focus States

DON'T:

```
input[type="search"] {  
  border: 1px solid #E0E0E0;  
  /* No focus state! */  
}
```

DO:

```
input[type="search"] {  
  border: 2px solid #E0E0E0;  
  transition: border-color 0.3s;  
}  
  
input[type="search"]:focus {  
  outline: none;  
  border-color: #2196F3;  
}
```

12.3 Mistake 3: Poor Highlight Contrast

DON'T:

```
mark {  
  background: #FFF0F0; /* Too subtle! */  
  color: #FFCCCC;  
}
```

DO:

```
mark {  
  background: #FFEB3B; /* Clear yellow */  
  color: #000;  
  font-weight: bold;  
}
```

13 Quick Reference

13.1 Search Input Styling

```
/* Basic search box */
input[type="search"] {
  padding: 12px 16px;
  border: 2px solid #E0E0E0;
  border-radius: 8px;
  font-size: 16px;
}

/* Focus state */
input[type="search"]:focus {
  outline: none;
  border-color: #2196F3;
  box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(33, 150, 243, 0.1);
}

/* Placeholder */
input[type="search"]::placeholder {
  color: #999;
}

/* Clear button */
input[type="search"]::-webkit-search-cancel-button {
  -webkit-appearance: none;
  appearance: none;
  width: 16px;
  height: 16px;
}
```

13.2 Text Highlighting

```
/* Highlight found text */
mark {
  background-color: #FFEB3B;
  color: #000;
  font-weight: bold;
  padding: 2px 4px;
}

/* Alternative: CSS class */
.highlight {
  background: #FFD54F;
  padding: 2px 4px;
}
```

13.3 Key Properties

- `padding` - Space inside input
- `border` - Input border
- `border-radius` - Rounded corners
- `font-size` - Input text size
- `:focus` - Focus state styling
- `::placeholder` - Placeholder text
- `::-webkit-search-cancel-button` - Clear button

Conclusion

CSS search text styling helps create effective, user-friendly search interfaces. From simple search boxes to complex result pages, CSS gives you the tools to build great search experiences.

Key Takeaways:

- Use proper padding for comfortable input
- Always style the focus state clearly
- Use high-contrast colors for highlights
- Make search mobile-friendly
- Provide visual feedback for searches
- Ensure good accessibility

Start building better search experiences with these CSS techniques!